





3. Tech Meets Truth Cross-verifying Aadhaar data, real-time photos and forensics of question paper leaks have led to hundreds of arrests

4. Encrypted Evidence Investigators retrieve WhatsApp and Telegram chats between candidates and middlemen

5. Judicial Watch: The Rajasthan High Court has ordered independent monitoring of recruitment exams to restore credibility

Terrorism Squad (ATS) busted a fake ex-servicemen racket in Jaipur; 28 people were arrested for securing Food Corporation of India (FCI) security guard jobs using forged discharge papers and pension papers. The investigators had verified all guards at 31 FCI depots—private security agencies had created fake ID cards, canteen passes and discharge certificates, for Rs 30,000-50,000 per candidate.

In the same month, the SOG uncovered a racket of bogus 'sports quota' credentials with the arrest of Hemlata Gurjar from Karauli district, who used a fake Taekwondo certificate to secure a Grade III teacher post. The investigators found that fake emails purportedly from the Taekwondo Federation of India were created to send forged verifications. At least half a dozen people, including Dinesh Jagarwal, general secretary of the Rajasthan Taekwondo Association, are accused of facilitating false entries into national championship rosters. Two others, Madhusudan from Ajmer district and Siya Ram from Karauli, both teachers, have been dismissed for using similar certificates to claim quota benefits.

Fraud has continued into promotions too—41 officers of the Rajasthan Apex Bank are under investigation for using fake PG degrees to gain two salary increments. Some of the universities cited had no campuses in the state; others claimed they never issued such degrees.

DIGITAL DECEIT

With recruitment going online, cheating followed it there too. During the National Seeds Corporation exam in Jaipur, the SOG found 'solvers' answering questions remotely through screen-sharing software installed in computer labs, as candidates sat idle. Two engineers, Jogendra Kumar Singh and Paramjit Kadiyan, who had themselves failed earlier recruitment exams, were arrested for running such labs. Investigators are still determining how many exams this network infiltrated.

Bluetooth-aided cheating has become one of the most sophisticated methods. Candidates enter exam halls with micro earpieces or masks and receivers stitched into vests or dupattas. Handlers outside the hall dictate answers using Wi-Fi hotspots or smartphones. In September, four high court junior clerks—Ram Prakash Jat, Sunil Bishnoi, Rakesh Jakhar and Om Prakash Jat—were arrested for allegedly using Bluetooth devices during the 2022 exam. Each reportedly paid Rs 5 lakh to the alleged mastermind of the scam, Paurav Kalar. Similarly, Manju Kumari Bishnoi was arrested from Bikaner in September for securing a women empowerment supervisor's post by using a Bluetooth device to receive answers during the 2018 exam.

PHANTOM CANDIDATES

Impersonation is another recurring modus operandi. Paid 'solvers' appear for others using forged IDs or tampered biometrics. In recent months, AI-based biometric systems have helped the SOG and ATS detect repeat offenders. The same 13 individuals were found impersonating candidates in two separate exams—for constable recruitment and for the diploma in elementary education.

One Dalu Ram Meena, a native of Dausa district and the first trainee SI to be arrested for using a dummy candidate in Jaipur last year, was rearrested this August along with his wife, Mausam, who allegedly impersonated a candidate in the 2022 senior teacher exam. Meena is accused of appearing in as many as eight exams on behalf of others, including for his relatives.

In Jaipur, SI Bhanwar Lal Bishnoi was arrested in September after a promotion exam for inspector; his handwriting was found to match that of a constable selected in 2013. In another case, Sagar Meena, a patwari in Ajmer district, had used one Roshan Lal Meena as his proxy in 2021; both were arrested. In Jodhpur, teacher Varsha was dismissed for taking the 2021 SI exam on behalf of three women; all were selected. Another teacher, Chammi Bai from Sanchore, was arrested for taking an exam for Manju Bishnoi, who later became an SI.

The crackdowns are encouraging, but meaningless without real change. Restoring credibility will require airtight systems, transparent evaluation and strong deterrence. ■